



4.07 Working on Ice and Ice Auger

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps for Working on Ice and Operating the Ice Auger.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by all Silverpoint employees.

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Equipment Damage and Failure
- Personal Injury
- Physical Stress
- Mental Stress
- Pinch Points
- Slips, Trips and Falls
- Extreme Weather Conditions
- Working Alone
- Ergonomics
- Lifting, Twisting, Pushing, Pulling

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls
- Steel Toed Boots
- Safety Glasses
- Gloves
- Hard Hat
- Guard for Auger
- Follow Procedure
- Lifting Techniques

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List



- Silverpoint THA 4.07
- Government of Alberta (Field Guide to working safely on Ice Covers)
- Manufacturers Operations Manual

6. Ice Surfaces and Types; Three types of ice may typically be encountered.

- Clear Blue Ice, which is strongest.
- White or Opaque Ice is less dense and, therefore, weaker than clear blue ice.
- Gray Ice, which is indicative of thawing ice and water. Gray ice is not considered load-bearing ice.

6.1. Effective Ice Thickness.

Effective ice thickness is defined as the good quality, well-bonded white and blue ice that is measured in an ice cover. Poor quality or poorly bonded ice should not be included in the measurement of ice thickness. The following are examples of ice that should be excluded from the measurements if they are encountered:

- Ice layer with water lens (>5 mm diameter) with a cumulative volume greater than 10% of the total volume.
- Ice layer with visible incompletely frozen frazil (slush) ice.
- Ice layer that is poorly bonded to the adjoining layer.
- Ice layer that has been found to have a strength less than 50% of good quality blue ice (a number of specialized methods are available for determining ice strength).
- Ice that has wet cracks.

When in doubt about the thickness of the ice and whether it's safe to go out on, contact your supervisor or person in charge of ice care.

7. Operation of Ice Auger (manual). Always refer to the Manufacturers Manual and recommendations before operating Auger.

- Put on all required PPE. Wear non-slip footwear or Ice Cleats.
- Secure loose clothing, and tie back long hair. Remove jewelry.
- Read and follow the manufacturer's instructions, precautions, and directions.
- Set the handle to correct height for the user—that is, no higher than the user's underarm when the blade is touching the ice.
- Uncover the blade then rest the blade on the ice. **The blades are extremely sharp so never run your fingers or hand over blade to check for sharpness.**
- Press down on the top knob of the handle with one arm close to the right shoulder if right-handed.
- While pressing down on the handle knob, use the other hand to turn the ice auger clockwise.
- Apply steady downward pressure.



- Once through the ice, turn the auger counterclockwise while pulling up on the handle.
- Cover the blade.
- Put away all tools, equipment, and materials in their proper storage areas.
- Clean the work area.

8. Operation of Ice Auger (powered). Always refer to the Manufacturers Manual and recommendations before operating the Auger.

- Start engine as explained in the manual. For best cutting performance, run engine at idle for 1-2 minutes before drilling.
- Hold the unit in a vertical position with your right hand pushing downward to open throttle, and your left hand firmly holding the opposite handle.
- This Auger produces considerable cutting force that is felt by the operator. Make sure your feet are firmly planted and that the handles are held firmly while operating this product (Ice cleats on your footwear are recommended).
- Push the throttle lever downward to increase the engine speed. As the engine speed increases the centrifugal clutch will engage and the auger will begin to rotate.
- During the operation of cutting, the auger could possibly stop if it comes in contact with a foreign object or if it binds in the hole. Be prepared at all times to release the throttle lever to avoid rotation of the handle assembly (newer models might have an emergency kill cord that you attach to your wrist).
- Stop engine if you notice a difference in the operating characteristics of this machine.
- Always stop the engine before any contact with the auger, even when clearing ice blockage.
- Never touch the muffler due to a risk of burns!
- **The cutting blades on this auger are razor sharp. Use extreme care when handling and installing blades and blade guards.**
- After using this machine, STOP the engine by allowing the engine to return to idle and moving the switch to the OFF position. If engine fails to stop, press the decompression valve in to shut off the engine. If the ignition switch has fails, DO NOT OPERATE until the ignition switch has been repaired by a qualified mechanic.
- Always check to make sure the throttle system is moving freely and returning to idle.
- Turn off this machine when traveling from site to site.
- It is recommended that the fuel be shut off while transporting Auger.
- Always store auger with blade guard attached.
- Always make sure the engine is off before re-fueling.

Remember: If you have questions or concerns, call your Supervisor